

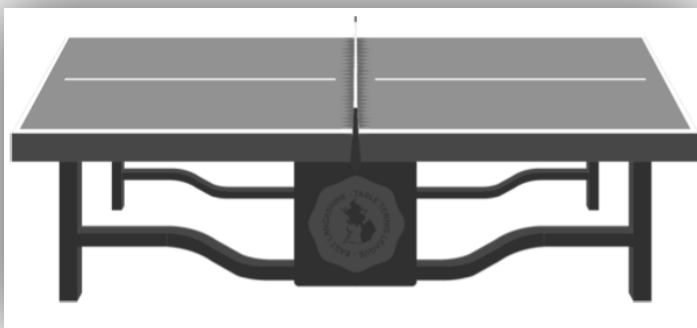


East Lancashire Table Tennis League



(Formerly known as the Hyndburn Table Tennis League founded in 1974)

Founded in 2001 and includes leagues from Hyndburn, Rossendale, Burnley, Nelson and the Ribble Valley



Season 2026 - 2027 Handbook

Affiliated to Table Tennis England and
the Lancashire County Table Tennis Association

eastlancstt.org.uk

A Message from the Committee.

Welcome to the new season and good luck. Let's hope we all enjoy our table tennis.

You may have noticed that Martin Wyatt has continued to work on improving aspects of the Website. This will be ongoing as we seek to improve it for players to use. Our thanks go to Martin for finding time to do this work.

Please be aware that we have moved some dates for competitions around a little - see the section in the Handbook. We are also experimenting with a closed under 16 competition in December. If it is a success we may hold it every season.

Please remember that the **start time for matches played at HTTC and St Peters Burnley has changed to 7.00**, whilst remaining at 7.30 for other venues. This has changed due to the centres enforcing a stricter 10.00 end to the evening. Also a reminder that if you are playing a Junior team at KSB please arrive by 7.00 ready for a 7.15 start.

Rule20b, introduced for when teams are playing a KSB Junior team, will remain for another year, after which it will be reviewed again. There have been some minor modifications of how it will be applied this season.

We also want to commend the work that Chris Freely has been doing with his Sunday Training sessions and encourage people to take part. You can contact Chris for details on 07484314667 or access the latest information via the East Lancs TTL WhatsApp group.

Finally we would like to draw your attention to the ITTF push to educate players to serve legally. When the Committee discussed this issue we identified two areas of concern within our own league. The first was to do with throwing the ball up from the flat of the hand at least six inches, as straight up as possible. The other was masking or hiding the ball behind the arm, head or body as we make contact with the bat as we serve, so that the receiver cannot see the spin we impart. To help all players with this we will be printing the relevant service rules on the website along with some links to useful YouTube videos that illustrate how to serve within the rules. These might hopefully help us all serve better.

If you need any help over the season with any ELTTL issues please contact your Divisional Representative or any member of the Committee who will be glad to assist.

Committee Members 2026-2027

Hon. Chairman	Ged Simpson	07933 267982
Hon. Vice Chairman	Ian Pickles	07879 633355
Hon. Secretary	David Heys	01254 608565/07849 958343
Asst Secretary	Vacant Post	
Hon.Treasurer	Martin Ormsby	07759 959823
Hon. Fixtures Secretary	Bernard Milnes	07881 610874
Assist. Fixtures Secretary	Mike Turner	07923 329920
Centre Liaison Officer	Robin Willoughby	07930 558587
Media Officer	Adam Hek	07713 920257
Welfare Officer	Catherine Lawson	07505 354318
Web Designer	Martin Wyatt	07794 723408
Handicap Officer	Grant Saggars	07939 367743
Tournament Team	Mike Turner	07923 329920
	Ian Pickles	07879 633355
Premier Div. Rep	Colin Hooper	07973 684517
First Div Rep	Ian Pickles	see above
Second Div Rep	Robin Willoughby	07930 558587
Third Div Rep	Fred Wade	07933 711830
InterLeague Secretary	Jason Pilling	07815 284429

Other Committee Members

Shom Bose	07774 787343
Michael Moir	07531 674059
Harry Rawcliffe	01254 498685
Chris Freely	07484 314667

The Welfare Officer

Catherine Lawson is our Welfare Officer.

If you have any concerns about an issue relating to the safeguarding of a young person or a vulnerable adult please contact Catherine on 07505354318. **Please**

Note The League is clear that Parents have overall responsibility for their Child's safety at all times

East Lancashire Table Tennis League Fixtures 2026-2027

This year all divisions are playing on a 10 Team matrix. We have 40 teams in the league this year so each division will have 10 teams. Every team has been allocated a number between 1-10, as is shown on the “**Teams, Venues and Secretaries**” page. Simply identify your number then look in the weekly columns to see who you are playing and if you are home or away. Left hand column is the Home and right hand column the Away Team. KSB Juniors play their matches at Home Only. Please can teams playing Monday at Kay St arrive at 19.00 for matches to start at 19.15. Matches at HTTC are now scheduled to start at 19.00.

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Information for all Divisons											
Premier Division Information						First Division Information					
Team	Night	Venue	Secretary	Contact (L)	Contact (M)	Team	Night	Venue	Secretary	Contact (L)	Contact (M)
KSB C	Tues	Kay St Rawtenstall	Matt Hodgkinson		07977003518	Vanguard Jets	Mon	Vanguard Com Ctr	Darren Wright		07736473609
KSB B	Wed	Kay St Rawtenstall	Craig Milnes		07834043694	KSB D	Wed	Kay St Rawtenstall	Bernard Milnes	01706 877391	07881610874
Spartans	Wed	HTTC	Simon Brooke		07935483769	Burnley Hornets	Thurs	St Peters Centre	Mick Swindells		07807636960
Gladiators	Wed	HTTC	Dave Kay		07523739464	Vanguard Tornados	Tues	Vanguard Com Ctr	James Balmforth		07885460165
Whalley Kestrels	Wed	Whalley Village Hall	Phil Mileham	01200425005	07837686746	Whalley Falcons	Tues	HTTC	Rafeeq Sulaiman		07522958003
Whalley Eagles	Mon	HTTC	Colin Hooper		07973684517	KSB F	Tues	Kay St Rawtenstall	Dave Mottershead		07516004063
KSB A	Wed	Kay St Rawtenstall	Daven Argile		07798713164	KSB E	Wed	Kay St Rawtenstall	Sam Richardson		07977935990
Burnley Black Widows	Wed	HTTC	Dave Eastwood		07783498667	Past Masters	Tues	HTTC	Ian Pickles		07879633355
Vanguard Raptors	Mon	Vanguard Com Ctr	Richard Tokeley		07970490191	Vanguard Phantoms	Mon	Vanguard Com Ctr	Ryan Fallon		07402899095
Rovers	Mon	HTTC	Ian Mason		07962308533	Misfits	Tues	HTTC	David Borland		07900472621
Second Division Information						Third Division Information					
Team	Night	Venue	Secretary	Contact (L)	Contact (M)	Team	Night	Venue	Secretary	Contact (L)	Contact (M)
KSB Jaguars	Tues	Kay St Rawtenstall	Simon Milnes		07904313895	Hyndburn TTC B	Mon	HTTC	Adrian Lawson		07306666473
Burnley Bees	Mon	Sion Church	Judith Glover		07456279590	KSB Pumas (Jun)	Mon	Kay St Rawtenstall	Trevor Elkington		07981387755
Whalley Ospreys	Thurs	HTTC	Phil Austin		07484262288	Burnley Dragon Flies	Thurs	St Peters Centre	Adam Simcock		07914844325
Slayers	Wed	HTTC	David Heys		07849958343	Vanguard Typhoons	Tues	Vanguard Com Ctr	Chris Wilkinson		07757664955
Hyndburn TTC A	Mon	HTTC	James Sheard		07986201069	Whalley Harriers	Wed	Whalley Village Hall	Peter Watson		07795685467
KSB G	Tues	Kay St Rawtenstall	Ian Clements		07503167547	KSB Leopards (Jun)	Mon	Kay St Rawtenstall	Trevor Elkington		07981387755
KSB Lions	Tues	Kay St Rawtenstall	Sam Hodgkinson		07958591242	Burnley Scorpions	Mon	Sion Church	John Lee		07510008396
Brierfield	Thurs	Brierfield Methodist	Peter Marsland		07805761863	Burnley Wasps	Thurs	St Peters Centre	Shamir Bose		07774787343
KSB Tigers	Mon	Kay St Rawtenstall	Trevor Elkington		07981387755	KSB Panthers (Jun)	Mon	Kay St Rawtenstall	Trevor Elkington		07981387755
Whalley Hawks	Wed	Whalley Village Hall	Andrew Brierley		07738761133	Whalley Merlins	Wed	Whalley Village Hall	Colin Hooper		07973684517
More information can be found i.e. league tables at https://eastlancstt.org.uk											

Calculating Handicaps using player’s rank

In an attempt to produce handicaps from actual player performances rather than from what players think they should be, a ranking system was created which was linked to our handicap system, this has been in use over the past seasons. To set up the system each point on the handicap chart was deemed to be equal to 35 racking points. A handicap of 0 is equal to 2600 ranking points so a handicap of 70 will be equal to 150 points. A full list is shown below.

Hd	Rank	Hd	Rank	Hd	Rank	Hd	Rank	Hd	Rank	Hd	Rank	Hd	Rank
0	2600												
1	2565	11	2215	21	1865	31	1515	41	1165	51	815	61	465
2	2530	12	2180	22	1830	32	1480	42	1130	52	780	62	430
3	2495	13	2145	23	1795	33	1445	43	1095	53	745	63	395
4	2460	14	2110	24	1760	34	1410	44	1060	54	710	64	360
5	2425	15	2075	25	1725	35	1375	45	1025	55	675	65	325
6	2390	16	2040	26	1690	36	1340	46	990	56	640	66	290
7	2355	17	2005	27	1655	37	1305	47	955	57	605	67	255
8	2320	18	1970	28	1620	38	1270	48	920	58	570	68	220
9	2285	19	1935	29	1585	39	1235	49	885	59	535	69	185
10	2250	20	1900	30	1550	40	1200	50	850	60	500	70	150

The results from every match played are used to constantly update players ranking values, so a player who is currently on a roll would be gaining more ranking points resulting in his handicap going down, the opposite would occur for a player going through a bad patch, his/her ranking total will drop and their handicap would go up. Handicaps are updated before the start of the divisional handicaps, before the start of the preliminary cup round, before the closed competitions and before every further cup round including the final. The Handicap Officer has the authority to review a player’s rank subject to Committee approval. The chart for awarding and deducting ranking points is shown below, this was copied from Table Tennis England.

Chart for Awarding Ranking Points				
	Expected Result		Un-expected Result	
Ranking Difference	Winner	Loser	Winner	Loser
0 - 24	+12	-8	+12	-8
25 - 49	+11	-7	+14	-9
50 - 99	+9	-6	+17	-11
100 - 149	+8	-5	+21	-14
150 - 199	+6	-4	+26	-17
200 - 299	+5	-3	+33	-22
300 - 399	+3	-2	+45	-30
400 - 499	+2	-1	+60	-40
500 and over	0	0	+75	-50

How to play an individual handicap match (not Fred Holden Cup)

1. All games are played up to 21 points.
2. The difference of handicap of both players when checked in the handicap table (see below) will give the start.
E.g. Tony Blair on 19 plays David Cameron on 71. So $71 - 19 = 52$, a difference of 52 when checked on the chart at the top of this page gives a start of 16, so Tony Blair starts on 0, David Cameron starts on 16 in each game.
3. The player with the highest handicap has the choice to serve first.
4. At least one player **MUST** start from love (0).
5. The maximum start allowed for any player is 16 points.
6. For calculating handicaps for doubles matches, add together the handicap numbers for the doubles team and divide by two, round up to the next whole number. Do the same for the opposing team and use the table above to calculate the start; For example: Nick Clegg (0) and Gordon Brown (30) making up one team would have a handicap total of 30, divide by 2 = 15. If they played David Cameron (19) and Margaret Thatcher (56) with a total of 75, divided by

2 = 37.5, which rounds up to 38. This means that Clegg and Brown would give Cameron and Thatcher $38 - 15 = 23$, a difference of 23 gives a start of 11.

Details for calculating and playing handicapped table tennis in this league

<u>Difference</u>	<u>Start</u>
1	1
2	2
3	3
4	4
5 - 7	5
8 - 9	6
10 - 11	7
12 - 13	8
14 - 16	9
17 - 19	10
20 - 23	11
24 - 28	12
29 - 34	13
35 - 41	14
42 - 49	15
50+	16

Handicap system for Fred Holden Cup 2026 - 2027

1. Each player's handicap rate as issued by the Handicap Officer prior to each round of the Cup is inserted onto the scorecard and the total of all three players is used as the team handicap which is their starting score.
2. Each match between individual players consists of 4 sets played up to 11. Remember 4 sets have to be played for each individual match. The score for each set is added to the team score and a cumulative total is kept.
3. Every single point in each set counts towards the team's total score so the more points won the better.
4. First player to reach 11 wins that set, no need for 2 clear points to win it.
5. After everyone has played each other the cumulative total for each team determines who has won the match. The highest cumulative team total wins the match.
6. As usual, amended handicap rates for each player will be issued before each round of the Fred Holden Cup.
7. You will notice that the Fred Holden handicap rates for the players are exactly double the standard handicap rate.

Example (based on 2012/2013 teams) of how to fill in the handicap scorecards for the Fred Holden Cup handicap matches:-

You will notice in this example that KSB F just win this match by 3 points.

East Lancashire Table Tennis League FRED HOLDEN CUP Handicap Match																							
HOME team										Handicap rate		AWAY team										Handicap rate	
BURNLEY BOYS CLUB												KSB F											
1	MARTIN WYATT									4		1	BERNARD MILNES									102	
2	DAVE KAY									12		2	PAUL MILNES									120	
3	ANDREA HARRISON									14		3	SIMON MILNES									126	
Team handicap starting score										30		Team handicap starting score										348	
		Set 1			Set 2			Set 3			Set 4			Score		Cumulative							
																H		A					
																30		348					
1v2		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			74		357					
3v1		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			118		366					
2v3		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			162		375					
3v2		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			206		384					
1v3		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			250		393					
2v1		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			294		402					
3v3		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			338		411					
2v2		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			382		420					
1v1		11	2	11	2	11	2	11	2	11	3	44	9			426		429					
Signed				Signed						Winners													
										KSB F				426									
														429									

Fred Holden Cup Scorecard Template

The template below can be used to score your match in the Fred Holden matches, the completed scorecard then either scanned and emailed to Mike Turner, or sent via post. The following templates can be scanned/photocopied for when you progress further than the first 4 rounds!

East Lancashire Table Tennis League FRED HOLDEN CUP match									
HOME team				AWAY team				FH Handicap rate	
1				1					
2				2					
3				3					
Team handicap starting score				Team handicap starting score					
Game 1		Game 2		Game 3		Game 4		Score	Cumulative
								HOME	AWAY
1v2									
3v1									
2v3									
3v2									
1v3									
2v1									
3v3									
2v2									
1v1									
Signed		Signed		Winners					

Winners of Individual Trophies 2025 - 2026

The Big Day

Singles

Winner: Chris Freely

R/Up: Jason Pilling

Doubles

Winners: Chris Hall & Daven Argile

Rs/Up: Tim Vaughan & Stuart Landes

Plate

Winner: Scott Fleming

R/Up: Ryan Fallon

The Vets

The Younger Vets

Winner: Chris Hall

R/Up: Ian Cockcroft

The Older Vets

Winner: Frazer McEwan

R/Up: Phil Mileham

The Divisional Handicaps

Premier & First

Winner: Martin Wyatt

R/Up: Simon Milnes

Second & Third

Winner: James Astle

R/Up: Alex Gavin

The Hard Bat

Winner: Tim Vaughan

R/Up: Frazer McEwan

The Divisional Winners 2025-2026

Premier Division

League Title

Winners: Ramsbottom A

Rs/Up: Spartans

Merit Table

Winner: Chris Freely (Spartans)

R/Up: Jason Pilling (Rammy A)

Doubles Merit

Winners: Ramsbottom A

Rs/Up: Spartans

First Division

League Title

Winners: KSB D

Rs/Up: Burnley Hornets

Merit Table

Winner: Shom Bose (Hornets)

R/Up: Keith Dale (KSB D)

Doubles Merit

Joint: Burnley Hornets & Vanguard Jets

Second Division

League Title

Winners: Vanguard Tornadoes

Rs/Up: KSB F

Merit Table

Winner: Dave Worrall (Tornadoes)

R/Up: Chris Green (KSB Lions)

Doubles Merit

Winners: KSB Tigers

Rs/Up: Joint KSB F & KSB Lions

Third Division

League Title

Winners: KSB G

Rs/Up: HTTC

Merit Table

Winner: Andy Cretney (KSB G)

R/Up: Alex Gavin (KSB Jaguars)

Doubles Merit

Winners: KSB G

Rs/Up: KSB Jaguars

The Fred Holden Handicap Trophy

Winners: Whalley Merlins

Rs/Up: KSB Tigers

The Bert Gibson Trophy

Mark Gleave

Rovers

SCHEDULE OF ELTTL COMPETITIONS FOR 2026-7 SEASON.

Please find below the proposed schedule for individual competitions for the upcoming season to be played at the HTTC. Be aware that we may need to alter these as the season progresses.

Please be aware that we are experimenting with an Under 16 Competition to be played on Monday 14th December. This is for younger players who play in the ELTTL.

The Committee has decided to continue with vouchers for another season at a rate of £70 for winners and £30 for runners-up as it has proven to be very popular.

Please note that these are CLOSED COMPETITIONS and individuals who don't play in the ELTTL are not eligible to enter.

Please be aware of Rule 32 relating to individual competitions. To play in the Vets & Divisional Handicap players must have played in at least two league or cup matches. For the Big Day this increases to 3 matches.

The Fred Holden Team Handicap Trophy is arranged independently of these competitions that are for individual players.

- **The Veterans Competitions**

These two handicap competitions will take place in the week beginning 14th December. On Tuesday 15th the Younger Vets (Over 40 but under 60) will take place, followed on Wednesday 16th by the Older Vets (Over 60). These will be played initially in a Round Robin format with winners progressing to a knockout stage.

- **The Divisional Handicap Competitions**

These will take place in the week beginning 1st February. On Monday 1st February the Premier & First Division Handicap Competition will take place and on Tuesday 2nd the Second & Third Division Competition. Each competition will be open to players in those divisions who are registered for a team in that division and have played at least two league matches. These are competitions based on handicaps derived from ranking points and will take the format of best of three games first to 21 points. A round robin stage will be followed by knockout rounds.

- **The ELTTL Closed Competition Day (The Big Day)**

*This full day event will take place on **Sunday 21st February**. The Committee will decide nearer the date which mix of formats will be played for alongside the Open Singles. Please note this later date than in previous years. This is for players who have played at least three games in the League.*

- **The Under 16 Closed Competition**

This new event is designed for younger ELTTL players who are Under 16 on the 31st August 2026. It will take place at HTTC on Monday 14th December. To enter players must be registered for an ELTTL team.

- **The Hard Bat Competition**

This fun event will be scheduled to take place at the end of the season. The date will be announced sometime early in 2027. This will be a round-robin event followed by knockout rounds. All players will use the League's hard bats.

If you have any questions about these competitions please contact Mike Turner or Ian Pickles.

Website

The website has been updated further, now results can be seen immediately and in much more detail.

- *Merit Table*
- *League Table*
- *Individual Player Results*
- *Individual Team Results*
- *Scorecards*
- *Archive of previous years*

eastlancstt.org.uk



Presentation Evening:-

Accrington Golf Club

Oswaldtwistle

on Saturday 1st May 2027

Annual General Meeting:-

Hyndburn Leisure Centre

Accrington

Wednesday 12th May at 7.30pm